

CarryLink End User Manual

Version: MVP user guide

This manual explains how end users can use CarryLink to send items with travelers, post trips, find matches, message other users, and follow safety rules. It is written for senders, travelers, and people who use the platform as both.

1. What CarryLink Does

CarryLink is a peer-to-peer travel delivery matching website. It helps people who live outside their home countries connect with travelers already going between two places.

Example: a Lebanese person living in Canada wants to send a small gift, document, or package to Lebanon. Instead of using expensive international shipping, the sender can find a traveler going from Canada to Lebanon and agree on handoff details, compensation, and delivery details.

CarryLink can also work in the opposite direction, such as Lebanon to Canada, or for other international routes.

CarryLink is a matching and communication platform. It does not inspect items, does not guarantee delivery, and does not replace airline, airport, customs, or destination-country rules.

2. Main User Types

Sender or Requester

A sender wants to send an item from one place to another. A sender can:

- Create a delivery request.
- Search for travelers.
- View suggested travelers.
- View matches.
- Message travelers.
- Agree on handoff and delivery details.

Traveler or Carrier

A traveler is already traveling between two places and may have available luggage space. A traveler can:

- Post a trip.
- State origin, destination, travel dates, and available space.
- Set accepted item types and restricted item types.
- Receive message conversations from senders.
- Review matching delivery requests.

Both

Some users may sometimes send items and sometimes carry items. These users can choose both roles during signup or in their profile.

3. Before You Start

You need an account before using the main platform functions. Registration is required before:

- Posting a trip.
- Creating a delivery request.
- Searching for travelers as a logged-in user.
- Messaging another user.
- Viewing dashboard information.
- Managing profile information.

You should also know:

- Your current country.
- Your home country.
- Your email and phone number.
- Whether you are mainly a sender, traveler, or both.

4. Creating an Account

1. Open CarryLink.
2. Select Sign up from the top menu.
3. Enter your full name.
4. Enter your email address.
5. Enter your phone number.
6. Enter your current country.
7. Enter your home country.
8. Choose your user type: Sender, Traveler, or Both.
9. Enter a password.
10. Submit the form.

After signup, you should be logged in and sent to your dashboard. If the website asks you to log in, use the same email and password you used during signup.

5. Logging In

1. Select Login from the top menu.
2. Enter your email address.
3. Enter your password.
4. Submit the form.

After login, the top right of the website should show your profile button instead of Login and Sign up.

6. Automatic Logout After Inactivity

For account safety, CarryLink logs users out after 2 minutes of inactivity.

Activity includes:

- Clicking.
- Typing.
- Moving the mouse.
- Scrolling.
- Touching the screen on mobile.

Auto-refresh for messages does not keep your session alive. If you stop using the website, the session timeout still logs you out.

7. Navigation Menu

The top menu gives quick access to:

- Home: the main page with explanation and suggested trips.
- Find Traveler: search for available traveler trips.
- Post Trip: create a new traveler trip.
- Matches: view route and date matches.
- Dashboard: see your requests, trips, matches, and conversations.
- Safety: read prohibited item and compliance guidance.
- Profile: manage your personal details when logged in.
- Logout icon: sign out when logged in.

8. Home Page Overview

The home page explains the CarryLink service and shows suggested posted trips. If you are logged in and your profile has a current country and home country, suggested trips are filtered to routes connected to at least one of those countries.

For example, if your current country is Canada and your home country is Lebanon, the default suggested trips may include:

- Canada to Lebanon.
- Lebanon to Canada.
- Canada to another country.
- Another country to Lebanon.

The home page can also show a new message badge on a trip when a related conversation has a new reply.

9. Updating Your Profile

1. Log in.
2. Select your profile button in the top right.
3. Review your profile fields.
4. Update your full name, email, phone number, current country, home country, or user type.
5. Optionally upload a profile photo.
6. Save the changes.

Your current country and home country are important because CarryLink uses them to suggest relevant trips.

10. Sender Scenario: Sending an Item

Use this scenario when you want to send something from one place to another.

Step 1: Create a Delivery Request

1. Log in.
2. Go to Create Delivery Request.
3. Enter the origin country.
4. Enter the origin city.
5. Enter the destination country.
6. Enter the destination city.
7. Choose your preferred date range.
8. Choose an item category.
9. Describe the item clearly.
10. Enter approximate size.
11. Enter approximate weight.
12. Choose whether the item is sealed.
13. Enter offered compensation.
14. Enter pickup flexibility.
15. Enter delivery flexibility.
16. Confirm the legal item checkbox.
17. Submit the request.

Step 2: Search for Travelers

1. Go to Find Traveler.
2. Use the From field to enter an origin country or city.
3. Use the To field to enter a destination country or city.
4. Optionally choose a travel date.
5. Select Search.

The search can match by country or city. If you choose a date, CarryLink searches for trips where the selected date is between the traveler's departure and arrival dates.

Step 3: Review Traveler Cards

Each traveler card may show:

- Traveler name.
- Route.
- Countries.
- Departure and arrival dates.
- Available luggage space.
- Accepted item types.
- Expected compensation.
- Match strength.
- View Details button.
- Send Message button.

Step 4: Message the Traveler

1. Select Send Message on a traveler card.
2. Write your message.
3. Include important context:
 - What you want to send.
 - Pickup city and area.
 - Delivery city and area.
 - Preferred date.
 - Whether the item can be opened for inspection.
 - Compensation offer.
4. Send the message.

Step 5: Agree on Details

Before handing over anything, both sides should agree on:

- Exact item description.
- Whether the traveler can inspect the item.
- Pickup location.
- Delivery location.
- Pickup time.
- Delivery expectations.
- Compensation.
- What happens if travel plans change.
- What laws or airline rules apply.

11. Traveler Scenario: Posting a Trip

Use this scenario when you are traveling and may carry a small item for someone.

Step 1: Post Your Trip

1. Log in.
2. Select Post Trip.
3. Enter From country.
4. Enter From city.
5. Enter To country.
6. Enter To city.
7. Choose a departure date.
8. Choose an arrival date.
9. Enter available luggage space.
10. Enter maximum item weight.
11. Enter accepted item types.
12. Enter items you do not accept.
13. Enter expected compensation.
14. Enter meeting preferences.
15. Add notes.
16. Submit the trip.

You cannot post a trip with a past departure date or past arrival date. The arrival date also cannot be earlier than the departure date.

Step 2: View Your Posted Trip

After saving a trip, go to Dashboard. Your trip should appear under My posted trips.

Step 3: Receive Messages

If a sender messages you about your trip:

- The conversation appears in My conversations.
- Trips with new messages may appear in the dashboard.
- The trip card may show a new message badge.

You cannot message yourself from your own trip. Your own trip card should show View Messages instead of Send Message.

Step 4: Reply to the Sender

1. Open Dashboard or Chat.
2. Select the conversation.
3. Read the sender's message.

4. Reply with your requirements.

Important traveler questions:

- What exactly is the item?
- Is it legal in origin and destination countries?
- Is it allowed by the airline?
- Can I inspect it before accepting?
- How much does it weigh?
- How large is it?
- Where will pickup happen?
- Where will delivery happen?
- What compensation is offered?

12. Using Matches

The Matches page shows route and date matches between trips and delivery requests.

Match strength labels include:

- Strong Match.
- Good Match.
- Possible Match.

A match may consider:

- Similar origin country.
- Similar origin city.
- Similar destination country.
- Similar destination city.
- Travel date fitting the request date range.
- Item weight fitting the trip capacity.

From the Dashboard, the My Matches section is clickable. Selecting a match opens the relevant match on the Matches page.

13. Chat and Conversations

The Chat page has:

- A conversation list.
- A message thread.
- A message input.
- A send button.

Use chat to coordinate details after finding a possible match.

Good first message example from a sender:

Hello, I saw your Montreal to Beirut trip. I want to send a small envelope with documents, around 0.2 kg. It can be opened and inspected. Pickup can be in Laval or downtown Montreal. Delivery is in Beirut. Are you comfortable carrying this?

Good reply example from a traveler:

Hi, yes, I can consider documents if they are legal and I can inspect them first. I am leaving on May 20 and arriving May 21. I prefer pickup near YUL or downtown Montreal. Please confirm the exact contents and whether customs declaration is needed.

14. Auto-Refresh for New Messages

CarryLink refreshes message-aware pages automatically so you can see new messages without manually refreshing.

Auto-refresh applies to:

- Home page.
- Dashboard.
- Chat page.

It refreshes only when you were recently active. It pauses when:

- You are typing.
- The browser tab is hidden.
- You have been inactive long enough that the session timeout should take over.

15. Dashboard Guide

The Dashboard shows:

- Active delivery requests.
- Posted trips.
- Open matches.
- Conversations.
- Trips with new messages.
- My active delivery requests.
- My posted trips.
- My matches.
- My conversations.

Use the dashboard as your main control center.

16. Safety Rules

Users must not send prohibited, illegal, dangerous, restricted, or undeclared items.

Examples of prohibited or restricted items include:

- Drugs.
- Weapons.
- Cash over legal limits.
- Alcohol or tobacco where restricted.
- Batteries or electronics where airline rules restrict them.
- Medicine without prescription or authorization.
- Any customs-restricted item.

Users are responsible for following:

- Airline rules.
- Airport rules.
- Customs rules.
- Origin-country laws.
- Destination-country laws.

CarryLink does not inspect items and does not guarantee delivery.

17. Safety Checklist for Senders

Before handing over an item:

- Confirm the item is legal.
- Confirm the item is permitted by the airline.
- Confirm the item is permitted by customs.
- Describe the item accurately.
- Do not hide restricted items.
- Let the traveler inspect the item.
- Do not pressure the traveler to accept.
- Agree on compensation clearly.
- Keep communication in the platform when possible.

18. Safety Checklist for Travelers

Before accepting an item:

- Ask what the item is.
- Inspect the item when possible.
- Refuse sealed or suspicious items if uncomfortable.
- Confirm weight and size.
- Confirm airline rules.
- Confirm customs rules.
- Refuse medicine, batteries, cash, liquids, or electronics if rules are unclear.
- Keep your own travel documents and luggage safe.
- Do not accept anything that creates legal risk.

19. Common User Scenarios

Scenario A: Sender in Canada Sends Documents to Lebanon

1. Sign up as Sender or Both.
2. Create a delivery request from Canada, Montreal to Lebanon, Beirut.
3. Choose a preferred date range.
4. Select Documents as the item category.
5. Confirm the item is legal and accurately described.
6. Search travelers from Montreal or Canada to Beirut or Lebanon.
7. Message a traveler.
8. Agree on inspection, pickup, delivery, and compensation.

Scenario B: Traveler Going Montreal to Beirut Posts Space

1. Sign up as Traveler or Both.
2. Post a trip from Canada, Montreal to Lebanon, Beirut.
3. Add departure and arrival dates.
4. Add available space, such as 3 kg.
5. Add accepted items, such as documents, clothing, or gifts.
6. Add items not accepted, such as medicine, batteries, liquids, or cash.
7. Review messages in Dashboard or Chat.

Scenario C: User Searches for a Traveler

1. Log in.
2. Open Find Traveler.
3. Enter From city or country.
4. Enter To city or country.
5. Add a date if needed.
6. Select Search.
7. Open View Details or Send Message.

Scenario D: Traveler Receives a Message

1. Open Dashboard.
2. Look for Trips with new messages.
3. Select View Messages.
4. Read the thread.
5. Reply to the sender.

Scenario E: User Updates Profile Countries

1. Open Profile.

2. Update current country and home country.
3. Save.
4. Return to Home or Find Traveler.
5. Suggested trips should better match those countries.

20. Troubleshooting

I cannot see Login and Sign up after logging out

Refresh the page or open the home page again. If still logged in, select the logout icon.

I am logged in but see Login and Sign up

Wait a moment or refresh. If the issue continues, log out and log in again.

My trip does not appear

Check that:

- You are logged into the same account that posted it.
- The departure date is today or in the future.
- The trip status is active.
- The trip was saved successfully.

Past trips are hidden automatically.

I cannot select a past trip date

This is expected. CarryLink does not allow posting trips with past dates.

I cannot message myself

This is expected. If the trip belongs to you, use View Messages to read conversations from other users.

I do not see new messages

Open Chat or Dashboard and wait a few seconds. The page refreshes automatically when you are active. If you are inactive for 2 minutes, you will be logged out for safety.

I see a hydration warning in development

Some browser extensions add attributes to inputs and buttons before the page loads. The app suppresses known harmless cases, but disabling form-filling extensions can remove the warning.

21. Best Practices

For senders:

- Be honest and specific about the item.
- Offer fair compensation.
- Keep the item small and simple.
- Do not ask travelers to carry anything questionable.
- Respect the traveler's right to refuse.

For travelers:

- Set clear restrictions.
- Do not accept items you cannot inspect.
- Decline anything suspicious.
- Keep all agreement details in writing.
- Prioritize legal and travel safety over compensation.

For everyone:

- Use clear communication.
- Meet in safe public places.
- Confirm identity before handoff.
- Follow all laws and rules.
- Report suspicious behavior when admin tools are available.

22. Quick Reference

To send an item:

1. Sign up.
2. Create delivery request.
3. Search travelers.
4. Message traveler.
5. Agree on details.
6. Follow safety rules.

To carry an item:

1. Sign up.
2. Post trip.
3. Wait for messages.
4. Review item details.
5. Agree or decline.
6. Follow safety rules.

To manage activity:

1. Use Dashboard.
2. Open My posted trips.
3. Open My delivery requests.

4. Open My matches.
5. Open My conversations.

23. Important Disclaimer

CarryLink is a platform for matching and communication. Users are responsible for their own decisions, agreements, legal compliance, airline compliance, customs compliance, and destination-country compliance.

CarryLink does not inspect items, does not verify item legality, does not guarantee delivery, and does not assume responsibility for user agreements.